

D398

Introduction to Pharmacology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A woman who teaches yoga and grows her own vegetables buys an herbal supplement for sleep at a large national pharmacy chain. The label says “all natural” and “clinically studied.” What is true about its regulation?

- A. It was approved by the FDA because a national chain sells it.
- B. It did not need FDA approval for safety or effectiveness before being sold.
- C. It went through the same FDA approval as prescription drugs.
- D. “All natural” means it has no drug interactions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which product must show safety and effectiveness to the FDA before it can be sold?

- A. A fish oil capsule.
- B. Any product sold in a pharmacy.
- C. A new prescription blood pressure drug.
- D. A vitamin D tablet.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A pharmacy that has been open since 1985 stocks oxycodone for patients after surgery. The pharmacist keeps it in a locked cabinet near the counter. Oxycodone is used medically and has high abuse potential. Which schedule is it?

- A. Schedule II
- B. Schedule I
- C. Not controlled, because it is prescribed.
- D. Schedule V

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A drug is listed as Schedule I. What does that mean?

- A.** High abuse potential and no currently accepted medical use in the U.S.
- B.** High abuse potential with accepted medical use.
- C.** Available over the counter with ID.
- D.** The safest schedule, with the lowest abuse potential.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 58-year-old man with high blood pressure and asthma takes a daily inhaled steroid. His provider is considering propranolol, a nonselective beta blocker. He jogs three mornings a week. What is the main concern?

- A.** It will raise his heart rate during jogging.
- B.** It is never used for high blood pressure.
- C.** It will reduce his steroid's effect on blood pressure.
- D.** It can cause bronchospasm and worsen his asthma.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A 12-year-old soccer player with asthma starts wheezing and coughing during a game. Her coach has a first-aid certificate. She has both an albuterol inhaler and a fluticasone (steroid) inhaler in her bag. Which should she use now?

- A.** Both, steroid first.
- B.** Neither until the coach checks her certificate.
- C.** Fluticasone, since it treats inflammation.
- D.** Albuterol, the short-acting rescue inhaler.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An older woman with heart failure takes furosemide and digoxin. She reports leg cramps and weakness. She lives with her sister and loves crossword puzzles. Which lab value is most important to check?

- A. Calcium, because furosemide raises it.
- B. Hemoglobin
- C. Potassium
- D. Blood glucose

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient on furosemide has a potassium level of 3.1 mEq/L (normal about 3.5–5.0). What change would a prescriber most likely consider?

- A. Nothing; 3.1 is within normal.
- B. Adding a potassium supplement or a potassium-sparing diuretic.
- C. Raising the furosemide dose.
- D. Stopping all heart medications.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A man with type 1 diabetes takes rapid-acting insulin before lunch, but a meeting runs long and he misses the meal. Thirty minutes later he is sweaty, shaky, and confused. His office is on the 12th floor. What is the best immediate action, if he can swallow?

- A. Walk him down 12 flights to get fresh air.
- B. Give about 15 grams of fast-acting carbohydrate, such as juice, and recheck in 15 minutes.
- C. Give another dose of insulin.
- D. Give a cheese sandwich.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient's mealtime rapid-acting insulin is due, but the lunch tray will not arrive for 90 minutes. When should the insulin be given?

- A.** Skip it for the day.
- B.** Now, on schedule.
- C.** When the meal is available, since it acts within about 15 minutes.
- D.** Double it with the next meal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A college student who plays in a band has a runny nose, sore throat, and mild cough for three days, with no fever. His roommate had the same thing last week. He asks for antibiotics before a big concert. What is the best response?

- A.** Give leftover antibiotics from his roommate.
- B.** Prescribe antibiotics so he recovers before the concert.
- C.** Antibiotics are never used for throat infections.
- D.** Explain that antibiotics do not treat viral colds and can drive resistance; suggest symptom relief.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A woman received her second chemotherapy dose 10 days ago. She calls to say she has a temperature of 101°F. She had been feeling well enough to plant tulips yesterday. How should this be treated?

- A.** As an urgent problem needing same-day evaluation, because her white count may be at its lowest.
- B.** As an allergic reaction to the chemotherapy.
- C.** As a minor side effect to watch at home.
- D.** As normal, since she felt well yesterday.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A woman ~~who teaches yoga and grows her own vegetables~~ buys an herbal supplement for sleep ~~at a large national pharmacy chain~~. The label says “all natural” and “clinically studied.” What is true about its regulation?

Target word: supplement regulation **Decides:** Supplements are not FDA-approved before sale.

A	Camouflage	Where it is sold does not mean FDA approval.
B	Correct	Under DSHEA, the maker is responsible; FDA acts mainly after problems arise.
C	Confusion set	Confuses supplement rules with drug approval.
D	Absolute language	Many supplements interact with drugs.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which product must show safety and effectiveness to the FDA before it can be sold?

Target word: reverse: which needs premarket approval **Decides:** New drugs, prescription or OTC.

A	Confusion set	A dietary supplement; no premarket approval.
B	Absolute language	Pharmacies sell many supplements that were never approved.
C	Correct	New drugs need FDA approval before marketing.
D	Confusion set	Also a supplement.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A pharmacy ~~that has been open since 1985~~ stocks oxycodone for patients after surgery. The pharmacist keeps it in a locked cabinet ~~near the counter~~. Oxycodone is used medically and has high abuse potential. Which schedule is it?

Target word: schedule from description **Decides:** High abuse potential plus accepted medical use.

A	Correct	High abuse potential with accepted medical use.
B	Confusion set	Schedule I drugs have no accepted medical use.
C	Absolute language	Being prescribed does not remove control status.
D	Inverted operation	Schedule V has the lowest abuse potential.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A drug is listed as Schedule I. What does that mean?

Target word: reverse: from schedule to meaning **Decides:** Schedule I definition.

A	Correct	That is the Schedule I definition.
B	Confusion set	That is Schedule II.
C	Adjacent category	Some Schedule V items may be; Schedule I cannot be prescribed.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses the order; Schedule V is lowest.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A 58-year-old man with high blood pressure and asthma takes a daily inhaled steroid. His provider is considering propranolol, a nonselective beta blocker. ~~He jogs three mornings a week.~~ What is the main concern?

Target word: contraindication **Decides:** Nonselective beta blocker plus asthma.

A	Inverted operation	Beta blockers lower heart rate.
B	Absolute language	Beta blockers are used for hypertension.
C	Confusion set	Mixes up the drugs' roles.
D	Correct	Blocking beta-2 receptors in the lungs narrows airways.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A 12-year-old soccer player with asthma starts wheezing and coughing during a game. ~~Her coach has a first-aid certificate.~~ She has both an albuterol inhaler and a fluticasone (steroid) inhaler in her bag. Which should she use now?

Target word: rescue vs. controller **Decides:** Acute symptoms need a fast-acting bronchodilator.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the priority; rescue first.
B	Camouflage	Delays treatment over an irrelevant detail.
C	Confusion set	A controller that works over days, not in an attack.
D	Correct	It opens airways within minutes.

7. Answer C Concept 5

An older woman with heart failure takes furosemide and digoxin. She reports leg cramps and weakness. ~~She lives with her sister and loves crossword puzzles.~~ Which lab value is most important to check?

Target word: key lab **Decides:** Loop diuretic plus symptoms of low potassium; digoxin risk.

A	Inverted operation	Loop diuretics lower calcium as well.
B	Confusion set	Weakness fits anemia, but the drug pattern points to potassium.
C	Correct	Furosemide lowers potassium; low potassium raises digoxin toxicity risk.
D	Adjacent category	Not the main risk with these drugs.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A patient on furosemide has a potassium level of 3.1 mEq/L (normal about 3.5–5.0). What change would a prescriber most likely consider?

Target word: reverse: from lab to action **Decides:** Low potassium on a loop diuretic.

A	Wrong stem number	3.1 is below the normal range.
B	Correct	Replaces or conserves potassium.
C	Inverted operation	Would lower potassium further.
D	Absolute language	An extreme response to a correctable problem.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A man with type 1 diabetes takes rapid-acting insulin before lunch, but a meeting runs long and he misses the meal. Thirty minutes later he is sweaty, shaky, and confused. ~~His office is on the 12th floor.~~ What is the best immediate action, if he can swallow?

Target word: hypoglycemia response **Decides:** Rapid insulin without food; conscious.

A	Camouflage	The floor number is irrelevant, and exertion lowers sugar.
B	Correct	Rule of 15 for a conscious person.
C	Inverted operation	Insulin lowers blood sugar further.
D	Confusion set	Fat and protein raise sugar too slowly for an acute low.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A patient's mealtime rapid-acting insulin is due, but the lunch tray will not arrive for 90 minutes. When should the insulin be given?

Target word: reverse: timing rule **Decides:** Rapid-acting insulin must be matched to food.

A	Absolute language	Needed with the meal; skipping entirely causes high sugar.
B	Inverted operation	Onset would come long before the food.
C	Correct	Giving it now risks low blood sugar before food arrives.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out matching to food and risks hypoglycemia.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A college student ~~who plays in a band~~ has a runny nose, sore throat, and mild cough for three days, with no fever. His roommate had the same thing last week. He asks for antibiotics ~~before a big concert~~. What is the best response?

Target word: antibiotic appropriateness **Decides:** Symptoms of a viral cold.

A	Inverted operation	Sharing partial courses fuels resistance and does not treat viruses.
B	Camouflage	The concert does not change a viral cause.
C	Absolute language	Bacterial strep throat is treated with antibiotics.
D	Correct	Stewardship avoids unneeded antibiotics.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A woman received her second chemotherapy dose 10 days ago. She calls to say she has a temperature of 101°F. ~~She had been feeling well enough to plant tulips yesterday.~~ How should this be treated?

Target word: fever during chemo **Decides:** Fever near the white-count nadir.

A	Correct	Neutropenic fever is a medical emergency.
B	Adjacent category	Fever at day 10 points to infection risk, not allergy.
C	Inverted operation	Underestimates infection risk at the nadir.
D	Camouflage	Yesterday's gardening doesn't change today's risk.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Drugs vs. dietary supplements under FDA rules	Prescription and over-the-counter drugs need FDA approval for safety and effectiveness before sale; dietary supplements (under DSHEA) do not, so the maker is responsible for safety and FDA acts mainly after problems appear.	Assuming “natural” or “sold in stores” means FDA-tested and approved.	A supplement described as approved, tested, or safe because it is on a shelf.
2	Controlled substance schedules	Schedule I has high abuse potential and no accepted medical use; Schedule II has high abuse potential with accepted use (most opioids, stimulants); abuse potential falls through Schedule V.	Thinking Schedule I is the least dangerous, or that medically used opioids are Schedule I.	A drug to classify, or a schedule to describe.
3	Beta blockers	Beta blockers (“-olol”) lower heart rate and blood pressure; nonselective ones can trigger bronchospasm in asthma, and all can hide the fast heartbeat of low blood sugar.	Thinking beta blockers raise heart rate or are safe in any lung disease.	A drug ending in -olol with asthma, diabetes, or a low pulse in the stem.
4	Rescue vs. controller inhalers	A short-acting beta-agonist (albuterol) opens airways within minutes for acute symptoms; an inhaled corticosteroid reduces airway inflammation over time and does not stop an attack.	Reaching for the steroid inhaler during an attack.	Sudden wheeze or shortness of breath vs. daily prevention.
5	Loop diuretics and potassium	Loop diuretics such as furosemide remove fluid and potassium; low potassium causes weakness and heart rhythm problems and raises digoxin toxicity risk.	Expecting potassium to rise on a loop diuretic.	Furosemide plus muscle cramps, weakness, or an abnormal rhythm.
6	Insulin timing and low blood sugar	Rapid-acting insulin starts within about 15 minutes and must be matched with food; shakiness, sweating, and confusion signal hypoglycemia, treated in a conscious person with about 15 grams of fast-acting carbohydrate.	Giving mealtime insulin when the meal is skipped, or treating low sugar with protein or fat.	Insulin given and a meal delayed or missed.
7	Antibiotics and stewardship	Antibiotics treat bacterial infections, not viral ones such as colds or flu; unnecessary use and stopping early drive resistance.	Expecting antibiotics to speed recovery from a cold.	A viral illness paired with a request for antibiotics.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Antineoplastic drugs and bone marrow suppression	Many chemotherapy drugs attack fast-dividing cells, including bone marrow, so white counts fall (the nadir, often 7-14 days after a dose) and infection risk rises; fever then needs urgent evaluation.	Treating a fever during chemotherapy as a minor side effect.	Days since chemotherapy plus fever or a low white count.

Course scope (public description): Introduction to Pharmacology will introduce learners to medication and supplement regulations and safety protocols. It provides an overview of the use, benefits, effects, and contraindications of commonly used drugs to treat conditions of the cardiovascular, respiratory, endocrine, nervous, and renal body systems. It also explores the types of anti-infective, antineoplastic, psychotropic drugs, and dietary supplements and their effects on the body.